CONTEXTUAL DATA INTEGRATION

Should the homepage check the forecast? Weather + geolocation at Burton

Real-time local weather joined to visitor geolocation, expressed as one contained homepage mechanic — and tested to an 11.6% conversion uplift across all users.

ROLE	TEAM	METHODS	OUTCOME
Personalization Specialist	Capita · Qubit ecosystem · Burton	External data integration · Geo-targeting · Creative rotation testing	+11.6% conversion uplift across all users

OVERVIEW

Making the site aware of the visitor's actual moment

Every physical Burton store adjusts to the world outside — window displays change with the season, mannequins dress for the weather. The website, the brand's *number one store*, did none of this: identical in a heatwave and a downpour. The project asked a simple integration question — what if the homepage checked the forecast? — and answered it with a measured test: real-time local weather joined to visitor geolocation, driving an 11.6% conversion uplift.

Embedded in the Arcadia ecosystem, I worked on contextual experiences under the program's simplicity philosophy: one contained mechanic, real data, a clean test.

01 — THE TENSION

Three gaps between retail instinct and digital experience

1 · CONTEXT BLINDNESS

The site knew a visitor's history but nothing about their *moment*. Customers respond to weather in predictable, commercially meaningful ways — rain sells umbrellas and, for travel brands, beach holidays. Burton's homepage served the same experience to a visitor in a downpour and one in a heatwave, leaving an obvious relevance signal unused.

2 · THE DATA LIVED OUTSIDE

This wasn't a collection problem — no survey, no new tracking. Weather data existed externally; visitor location existed internally via IP geolocation. The entire opportunity was an *integration*: two datasets, one join key (location), and the freshness to make the join meaningful in-session.

3 · THE GIMMICK RISK

Contextual personalization fails when it's clever instead of useful. The counter-design: one contained mechanic (a single homepage tile), genuinely useful routing (weather-appropriate products), and a proper test — because a mechanic this novel had to earn its place with a number, not a demo.

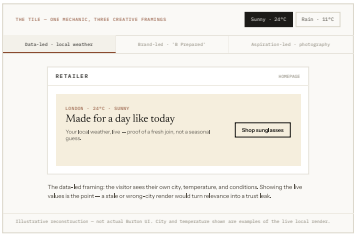
> *The brand's oldest retail instinct — dress the window for the weather — was missing from its biggest store. The fix wasn't more data about the customer. It was better use of data about their world.*

02 — THE CRAFT

Building the weather-aware experience

From data join to store-window logic. Try the demo: change the visitor's local weather, then switch between the three creative framings the tile rotated.





THE STORE-WINDOW FRAME

"Our number one store is our website. Our number two store is our mobile site."

— Richard Wilson, Burton

Weather targeting as the digital equivalent of dressing the shop window — an old retail instinct delivered through new data plumbing.

03 — IMPLEMENTATION

Rigorous execution

The experience ran as a **test**, and the result was decisive: an **11.6% conversion uplift across all users.** For a single contained homepage mechanic, that is an unusually large effect — which is itself the finding: contextual relevance on the highest-traffic surface moves the whole funnel behind it.

The integration was **real-time by design.** Showing the visitor their own city's weather and temperature wasn't decoration — it was proof of freshness. A stale join (yesterday's weather, wrong city) would have converted a relevance signal into a trust leak. Freshness and join accuracy were the quality bars.

And the mechanic honored the program's **simplicity discipline**: one tile, three creatives, one measurable question. No sitewide re-architecture, no speculative complexity — the smallest possible expression of the idea, tested properly.

04 — THE EVIDENCE

Measuring the lift

11.6%
conversion uplift across all users, from the weather-targeting test on the homepage tile

Real-time
the data join — live local weather and temperature joined to IP geolocation, rendered in-session

3
creative framings rotated — data-led (local weather), brand-led ('If Prepared'), aspiration-led (styled photography)

No. 1 store
the surface — deployed on the website, the brand's highest-revenue "store," with mobile as store number two

THE GROWTH

Key learnings

Context is a dataset
The highest-leverage signal in this project wasn't collected from users at all — it was the world around them, joined in. That inverted how I scope personalization: before asking "what more can we learn about the customer?", ask "what do we already know about their moment?" Integration often beats collection.

The shop-window principle
Physical retail has personalized by context for a century — displays change with weather, season, and street. Digital contextual relevance isn't a gimmick; it's the oldest merchandising instinct finally reaching the flagship store. Framing it that way is also what won stakeholders: not "an algorithm," but "dressing the window."

Contain the mechanic
Scoping the idea to one tile made everything else possible: a clean test, a legible result, a safe rollback, and a fast decision. Testability is a design constraint, not an afterthought — the best experiment is the one whose surface area matches its question.

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Contextual personalization within the Arcadia Group ecosystem for Burton. Proprietary metrics generalized for confidentiality.